

Juan-Andrés Castro

RESEARCH STATEMENT

I am a development economist focused on applying cutting-edge methods to understand and evaluate production and technology adoption in both public and private sectors. My work examines how new technologies affect organizations performance and public sector operations in the presence of frictions such as limited state capacity and information asymmetries.

EDUCATION

2023 – **Queen Mary University of London**
PHD IN ECONOMICS

2023 **Queen Mary University of London**
MRES IN ECONOMICS (DISTINCTION)

2018 **University of Chile**
M.SC. IN ECONOMICS (DISTINCTION)

2016 **University of Chile**
B.SC. IN ECONOMICS (DISTINCTION)

WORK EXPERIENCE

2018 – 2021

Central Bank of Chile

Research Analyst, Micro-Finance Unit

Drafted sections of the Financial Stability Report. Developed machine-learning models in Python to predict firm default. Built and managed large-scale datasets in Stata and MATLAB, including geocoding and spatial processing in QGIS. Coordinated international workshops.

WORK IN PROGRESS

2026 **How do communication technologies impact the state provision?**

2026 **Internet providers, political regimes and economic impact of connectivity**
with Jonas Hjort and Emilio Guaman.

2026 **Data centers impact on economics outcomes**
with Jonas Hjort and Ana Cepeda.

WORKING PAPERS

2023 **Financial constraints and firm adjustments during a sales disruption**
with Enzo Cerletti

2020 **Telling schools apart: preferences and restrictions in school choices**
with Nicolás Grau & Diego Amador.

POLICY REPORTS

2019 **Central Bank of Chile, Predictive models of default and recovery of corporate loans**
Castro, Cerletti, Fernández, & Vásquez.

2019 **Central Bank of Chile. Financial Stability Report - S2 2019 (Box IV.2: "Economic groups as a unit of analysis for financial stability," pp. 59–61)**
with Patricio Toro.

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RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIPS

2022 – 2024 **Jonas Hjort, UCL**

2022 – 2023 **Pedro CL Souza, QMUL**

2021 **Kirill Borusyak, UCL**

2018 – 2019 **William Mullins, UC San Diego**

2015 – 2018 **V. Paredes, F. Duarte, F. Pino, A. Micco, U de Chile**

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2023 – 2025 **TA, Queen Mary University of London**
Macroeconomics I & Quantitative Methods using R (×3)

2016 – 2017 **Instructor, Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez - Chile**
Econometrics I (×2)

2013 – 2017 **TA, University of Chile**
IO & Econometrics (×4)

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2021 **PhD Scholarship (ANID, Chile)**

2021 **QMUL PhD Scholarship**

2017 **COES Scholarship (project quality)**

2016 **Best in Business Award & Grunwald Scholarship**

2013 – 2015 **Circle of Excellence, University of Chile (top 5% cohort)**

TECHNICAL AND LANGUAGE SKILLS

CAUSAL METHODS causal inference from observational data (e.g., RDD, IV, DiD, Event-studies)

MACHINE LEARNING causal forests and classification methods (e.g., random forest, trees)

PROGRAMMING R, STATA/MATA, MATLAB, Python, Q-GIS, LaTeX

LANGUAGES Spanish (native), English (fluent), French (fluent)

LLMS WORKFLOWS Claude Code (Skills, Hooks, Agents)

OTHER INTERESTS

SPORTS Volleyball, long-distance running